

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Cooks and Kitchen Staff English



Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Line cooks, prep cooks, kitchen assistants, and dish-team colleagues.

All situations, quantities, recipes, times, and product details are fictional English practice, not culinary certification or food-safety instruction. This course does not teach cooking temperatures, chemical use, equipment repair, or allergen-control procedures. Follow workplace training and the responsible kitchen lead's decisions. It concerns kitchen communication rather than hospitality management.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

- 01 A revised event count reaches the kitchen
- 02 A substitute arrives without a clear message
- 03 Two voices call the same correction
- 04 An estimate belongs to a particular ticket
- 05 A substitution changes the description
- 06 A verbal amendment arrives after a ticket
- 07 A missing utensil changes the station update
- 08 The next shift inherits a count difference

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

All situations, quantities, recipes, times, and product details are fictional English practice, not culinary certification or food-safety instruction. This course does not teach cooking temperatures, chemical use, equipment repair, or allergen-control procedures. Follow workplace training and the responsible kitchen lead's decisions. It concerns kitchen communication rather than hospitality management.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A revised event count reaches the kitchen

A prep cook checks how a changed meal count affects an existing assignment.

Roles: Prep cook / Lead cook

Prep cook: The event count changed from thirty to thirty-six. Does that change every item on my prep list?

Lead cook: Not every item. The organizer added six main meals, but the dessert count remains at thirty today.

Prep cook: I have one sheet saying thirty portions throughout. Is there an updated list showing the different targets?

Lead cook: Yes, this revision separates the mains from desserts. Please use it instead of the earlier combined sheet.

Prep cook: The soup appears as a starter on the old list. Are six extra starters included as well?

Lead cook: That hasn't been confirmed. Keep the starter target at thirty while I ask the event contact directly.

Prep cook: Then I can report thirty-six mains and thirty desserts confirmed, with the possible extra starters still open?

Lead cook: Exactly. Don't turn the revised attendance figure into an instruction to increase every component by six.

Prep cook: Who should tell the other prep cook? They may still be using the old combined list over there.

Lead cook: I'll brief them now. Could you read back your two confirmed targets before you return to your station?

Prep cook: Thirty-six main portions and thirty desserts. The starter quantity stays at thirty unless you confirm a further change.

Lead cook: Correct. I'll return with a specific starter decision.

Notice the professional language

prep list - A list of ingredients or components to prepare before or during service.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A substitute arrives without a clear message

A cook and receiving lead compare an actual delivery with the planned ingredient order.

Roles: Cook / Receiving lead

Cook: The supplier sent diced peppers, but the order lists whole peppers. The case counts happen to match.

Receiving lead: Did the delivery note identify that as a substitution, or does it still name the original product?

Cook: It still says whole peppers. The driver called it an equivalent item, but there's no written change.

Receiving lead: Then matching case numbers doesn't settle the product difference. I'll contact the supplier about the incorrect description.

Cook: Should I tell the prep team the ingredient is available, or would that hide the unresolved substitution?

Receiving lead: Tell them a different product arrived and is awaiting review. Don't describe it as the ingredient they requested.

Cook: Their prep list depends on a specified product. I don't know whether this one suits the planned recipe.

Receiving lead: That's a decision for the kitchen lead after reviewing the actual product information, not just the supplier's description.

Cook: I'll give the lead both product names and the quantity received so they can assess the difference.

Receiving lead: Please also say the delivery record still names whole peppers; that record will need an accurate resolution.

Cook: Understood. The stock count is five cases, but product acceptance and the record correction are both unresolved.

Receiving lead: I'll ask the supplier; the lead will review product suitability.

Notice the professional language

delivery note - A supplier's document listing items and quantities sent with a delivery.

prep list - A list of ingredients or components to prepare before or during service.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Two voices call the same correction

A cook checks whether duplicate messages request one remake or two.

Roles: Cook / Expediter

Cook: You and the server both called a replacement soup for table ten. Is that one request repeated?

Expediter: Yes, one replacement only. The server spoke first, and I repeated it without saying it was the same.

Cook: I'll count one, then. Which ticket should carry the remake so another cook doesn't start a duplicate?

Expediter: Use ticket eighty-two. The replacement is for the diner at seat three, not the whole table.

Cook: The ticket also shows two original soups. Are either of those still waiting to be prepared?

Expediter: No, both originals were served. Only this single replacement remains open for the soup station now.

Cook: Thanks. I'll separate completed original orders from the new replacement when I report the outstanding quantity.

Expediter: Please also tell the server I've accepted their request, so they don't call it through again.

Cook: I can confirm acceptance, but the wait estimate still needs checking against the station's current work.

Expediter: That's fine. I'll explain that distinction to the server and ask them to wait for your estimate.

Cook: Then we have one outstanding replacement on eighty-two, seat three, and no additional original soups pending.

Expediter: Exactly. That shared count should stop a repeated message turning into a second production request.

Notice the professional language

'One request repeated' distinguishes duplicate communication from duplicate demand.

'Remains open' applies to the outstanding item, even when the original dishes were served.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

An estimate belongs to a particular ticket

A busy cook and expeditor untangle two timing updates.

Roles: Expediter / Cook

Expediter: You said five minutes, but I didn't catch the ticket number. Was that for thirty or thirteen?

Cook: Five minutes is my estimate for thirty. Thirteen has its mains at the pass for checking.

Expediter: Thanks. The server for thirteen heard that number and thought their order had another five-minute delay.

Cook: Please correct that with them. My update concerned thirty's unfinished dishes, not the completed mains for thirteen.

Expediter: I'll check thirteen before calling its pickup. Does thirty's estimate include both the main and its side?

Cook: It includes the main only. The side station hasn't given me a time for their component yet.

Expediter: Then I can't describe the whole of thirty as five minutes away. I'll get the side-station update.

Cook: Exactly. Tell them the main estimate, so they can discuss the full table's timing with you.

Expediter: The side station estimates six minutes. I'll coordinate the pickup around both components rather than the earlier number.

Cook: Please call the full ticket number when you update the server; the similar numbers caused the first confusion.

Expediter: I will. Thirteen is being checked at the pass; thirty's full pickup is currently estimated at six minutes.

Cook: That matches our latest information. I'll report any change directly.

Notice the professional language

'Concerned thirty' identifies which order the update was about.

'Includes the main only' limits the estimate's scope; it does not cover every component.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A substitution changes the description

A cook and server discuss a proposed alternative that would change the dish being offered.

Roles: Server / Cook

Server: We're out of the vegetable tart. Does the pasta alternative include the same side salad?

Cook: No, the pasta comes without that salad. Please explain the difference before the guest decides.

Server: They asked for a lighter meal, so I'll check whether pasta still appeals to them.

Cook: Please check the menu price with them too. It may affect which alternative they choose.

Server: I'll do that. Is the pasta definitely available, or am I offering something whose count needs checking?

Cook: We have four unallocated portions right now. I'll confirm the remaining count when you bring their choice back.

Server: Can you reserve one while I speak to them, or would that require the expeditor's approval here?

Cook: Ask the expeditor about this ticket's allocation. I haven't reserved a portion just by describing the current count.

Server: Understood. I'll say pasta is the proposed alternative, without promising a reservation or an identical accompaniment.

Cook: Please bring back the guest's choice before changing the ticket.

Server: I'll use the actual dish name on the revised ticket and identify which original order it replaces.

Cook: Then we can verify the accepted dish and its side details.

Notice the professional language

'Alternative' means another choice, not an equivalent product.

'Unallocated' means not yet assigned; it doesn't establish that a portion has been reserved for this guest.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A verbal amendment arrives after a ticket

A cook and server clarify a dietary concern added after the initial order.

Roles: Cook / Server

Cook: I've received a note saying 'change the sauce' for ticket forty, but it doesn't give a reason.

Server: The diner asked about an ingredient after ordering. I should have explained the concern with the amendment.

Cook: What exactly did they say? I need their words before the lead can assess the requested change.

Server: They said they avoid mustard and asked whether this sauce contains it. They haven't explained why yet.

Cook: Please ask whether they're reporting an allergy or a preference, and keep their food order pending meanwhile.

Server: I'll ask directly. I won't assume the answer just because their first request sounded casual at the table.

Cook: The lead also needs the actual sauce name; this ticket includes two dishes with different sauce components.

Server: The dietary modification concerns the side-salad dressing, not the sauce with the main.

Cook: Thank you. I'll identify the dressing and the unchanged main separately when I pass the question to the lead.

Server: I'll tell the diner which component we're checking and ask for their stated concern without suggesting an answer.

Cook: Then we can review the current dressing information before agreeing that a substitution addresses what they need.

Server: Yes. I'll get their answer before we suggest a replacement.

Notice the professional language

dietary modification - A requested change to a dish related to a diner's stated dietary need or choice.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A missing utensil changes the station update

A cook and lead coordinate work when a needed utensil cannot be located.

Roles: Cook / Lead cook

Cook: Our serving utensils aren't all back from the dish area. Should I call the station ready?

Lead cook: Tell me which item is missing and what remains incomplete, rather than using a general readiness label.

Cook: The small serving ladle is missing. The ingredient count and the rest of the setup are complete.

Lead cook: Have you asked the dish lead whether it's still in their area or already returned elsewhere?

Cook: They confirmed it's not yet returned, but they haven't located it. I don't know where it is.

Lead cook: Then report setup partly complete, with that utensil outstanding. I'll check whether a suitable replacement is available.

Cook: Should I borrow the other station's ladle now? They appear to have an extra one beside their setup.

Lead cook: Don't assume it's spare. I'll ask their lead about its allocation before deciding whether it can move.

Cook: I'll leave their setup unchanged and give our expeditor the specific reason our station isn't fully ready.

Lead cook: Good. The other station confirms its extra ladle is allocated, so we'll need a different replacement option.

Cook: I'll keep our utensil request open. The completed ingredient count doesn't need repeating when the replacement arrives.

Lead cook: Once we have a replacement, just update that outstanding item.

Notice the professional language

'Not yet returned' doesn't establish whether an item is lost.

'Allocated' explains why an item visible at another station may not be available to borrow.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

The next shift inherits a count difference

Two cooks compare a spoken handover with a stock record before changing the next shift's plan.

Roles: Incoming cook / Outgoing cook

Incoming cook: Your spoken update said fourteen portions, but the stock sheet says sixteen. Which count is current?

Outgoing cook: Fourteen was my physical count just before handover. The sheet may still show the earlier count.

Incoming cook: Do you know why two portions differ, or are you only reporting the numbers you can see?

Outgoing cook: I only know the figures differ. I haven't matched the change to orders or a waste entry.

Incoming cook: Then we should leave the reason unresolved. Who will reconcile the physical count with the records?

Outgoing cook: I'll bring the discrepancy to the lead. Could you use fourteen as the observed count in our discussion?

Incoming cook: Yes, as an observed count, not a final reconciled figure or confirmation that all portions are available.

Outgoing cook: That's an important distinction. The lead also needs to confirm any allocations before updating the service availability.

Incoming cook: I'll keep the next prep decision pending until that availability figure is clear. Can you stay for the review?

Outgoing cook: I can stay for the handover discussion and show the lead where the fourteen portions were counted.

Incoming cook: Then I'll tell the next station that the count is under review, with the difference and owner identified.

Outgoing cook: I'll retain this follow-up until the lead explicitly accepts responsibility.

Notice the professional language

'Observed count' states what was counted without claiming the records agree.

'Retain this follow-up' makes ownership explicit until another person accepts it.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Clarifying a prep list

SHARED CASE

The prep list says 'soup: 24' without a unit. Yesterday's sheet used portions; the storeroom label uses containers. The lead intended 24 portions from the current recipe, not 24 containers. No batch has started.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify quantities before interpreting a kitchen shorthand. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Lead cook: confirm 24 portions using Monday's recipe; container numbers are storage counts.

Useful expressions

Does ___ mean portions or ___?

Which recipe version applies to ___?

So the required yield is ___, not ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

The soup line says twenty-four, but it doesn't specify portions or containers. Before I start a batch, could you confirm the unit and the recipe version? Yesterday's sheet used portions, while the storage label counts containers. I'll repeat the required yield once we know which quantity today's prep list means.

Second round

The cook finds a second sheet dated Friday. Identify which sheet governs today's task.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Reporting deliveries and stock discrepancies

SHARED CASE

The delivery note lists six cases of tomatoes; four are physically present. The driver says two may be on another trolley but has not checked. The receiving lead must resolve the record. Report the observed count without accusing the supplier or recording six as received.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish a physical count from an expected quantity. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Driver: six are on the note; you haven't checked the second trolley yet.

Useful expressions

The note lists ____; I counted ____.

We haven't established whether ____.

Could you reconcile ____ before ____?

Cover this until after your first attempt

I can count four tomato cases here, while the delivery note lists six. Two may be on the other trolley, but that hasn't been checked. Please keep the received quantity unconfirmed until the receiving lead reconciles the count. I'll show them the four cases and the delivery note together.

Second round

The driver finds one more case. Update the observed count to five without declaring the delivery complete.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Reading tickets and modifications

SHARED CASE

Ticket 41 originally has two tarts. A new slip says 'three tarts, revised 41.' The expediter confirms this replaces the old quantity, so the total is three, not five. One tart has salad instead of potatoes. Confirm quantity and substitution.

Role A | Responding professional

Read back ticket identity, revised quantity, and the exact change. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Expediter: confirm three total, one salad substitution, and two standard accompaniments.

Useful expressions

Is this an addition or a correction to ___?

That's ___ total on ticket ___.

One with ___ instead of ___; the others ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Does the revised ticket replace the two-tart quantity on ticket forty-one, or add three more? If it replaces it, I have three tarts total, with salad instead of potatoes on one. Please confirm that modification applies to only one tart so I don't change all three plates.

Second round

Someone calls 'three more' after the correction. Repair the quantity before work continues.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Coordinating the pass

SHARED CASE

Ticket 28 has four mains. Two are plated; two are still at the cook's station. The cook estimates four more minutes for the remaining pair. The expeditor asks whether the whole table is ready. Report partial progress and the current estimate.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate individual dish progress from readiness of the full order. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Expediter: ask what is plated and whether the estimate covers the remaining pair.

Useful expressions

___ of ___ dishes are ___.

The remaining ___ need approximately ___.

Please wait for ___ before calling ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Ticket twenty-eight is not complete yet. Two mains are plated, and the other two are still at my station. My current estimate for that pair is four more minutes. Please don't call the full pickup yet. I'll update you when the remaining dishes are ready for your check at the pass.

Second round

The runner points to the two plated dishes and assumes the whole ticket can leave.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Communicating a shortage and an alternative

SHARED CASE

Three portions of potatoes remain unallocated, but a new ticket requests five. Rice is available as a proposed alternative side; the server must check whether two diners accept it. The cook cannot silently substitute. Agree who obtains the diners' decision.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a shortage and obtain the missing choice. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Server: you can ask the five diners, but cannot choose two seats for them.

Useful expressions

We have ___ left for ___ requested.

We can offer ___ if ___.

Please confirm which seats accept ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

We have three unallocated potato portions for this five-meal ticket. Rice is available as an alternative for two meals, but the guests haven't agreed to that change. Could you ask which two diners, if any, would accept rice? I'll keep the original request clear until you bring back their choices.

Second round

Only one diner accepts rice. Restate the remaining shortage and ask the lead about another option.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Checking dietary modifications

SHARED CASE

Ticket 17 says 'no cheese.' The server then reports that the diner has a milk allergy. The sauce specification has not been checked. The cook must not treat omission of cheese as confirmation that the dish is suitable; the lead can review it with the server.

Role A | Responding professional

Challenge an overbroad conclusion using the stated dietary concern. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Server: the milk allergy was reported after the initial no-cheese modifier. Relay that change exactly.

Useful expressions

Omitting ___ does not establish ___.

The new information is ___.

We still need the lead to check ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Removing the cheese answers the original modifier, but it doesn't establish that the dish meets this guest's milk-allergy concern. We haven't checked the current sauce specification or the handling question. Please keep ticket seventeen pending while the kitchen lead reviews those details and the server explains what remains unconfirmed to the diner.

Second round

The guest says another restaurant makes it without cheese. Explain why that doesn't verify this recipe.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Reporting equipment and dish-station needs

SHARED CASE

The display on scale B at the pastry prep bench keeps going blank. No cause is known. The cook has stopped using it and needs the lead to arrange review and confirm whether scale A is available. Do not offer repair instructions.

Role A | Responding professional

Request a named response to an observed equipment problem. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Lead: you can arrange review; scale A's availability is not yet confirmed.

Useful expressions

The ___ at ___ is ___.

I observed ___; the cause is unknown.

Could you confirm an available ___?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Scale B at the pastry prep bench keeps losing its display. I've stopped using it, and I don't know the cause. Could you arrange a review and confirm whether scale A is available for this assignment? The pastry prep quantity remains unverified, so I need a confirmed alternative before reporting that task complete.

Second round

The colleague asks whether the fault will be fixed before service. Keep the completion time unconfirmed.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Closing and handing over unfinished work

SHARED CASE

At shift change, the garnish count is complete at twelve portions, the waste-log entry for three damaged tarts awaits the lead's review, and the closing shelf check has not been performed. Ask the incoming cook to accept the shelf check without treating the waste review as complete.

Role A | Responding professional

Transfer closing work without making incomplete checks disappear. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Incoming cook: accept the shelf check and ask who retains the waste-log follow-up.

Useful expressions

___ is complete; ___ awaits review.

Can you take ___ and confirm ___?

I'll retain responsibility for ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

The garnish count is complete: twelve portions. The entry for three damaged tarts is in the waste log, but the lead hasn't reviewed it yet. The closing shelf check hasn't been done. Can you take that check and confirm when it's complete? I'll follow up with the lead about the separate waste-log review.

Second round

The lead is unavailable now. Keep review pending rather than treating silence as sign-off.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Twenty-four what?

The ambiguous soup prep line in the case.

01 • Prep cook: The soup line says twenty-four. Does that mean individual portions or filled storage containers?

02 • Lead cook: It means twenty-four portions today. We haven't specified a number of containers on this list.

03 • Prep cook: Thanks. Which recipe version should I use to check the required yield for that quantity?

04 • Lead cook: Use Monday's current recipe. The older sheet in the folder has a different yield.

05 • Prep cook: I'll work from Monday's version, then. Has anyone already started part of this batch?

06 • Lead cook: No, you're taking the whole soup assignment. The other cook is preparing salad components instead.

07 • Prep cook: So twenty-four portions is the total target, not twenty-four more than someone else's preparation?

08 • Lead cook: Correct. That's the total for your assignment, and nothing has been counted toward it yet.

09 • Prep cook: I'll mark the unit on my copy and repeat the target at the prep check.

10 • Lead cook: Good. Bring me any recipe discrepancy before assuming the older figures still apply today.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A total, not an addition

A kitchen assistant clarifies a revised list during preparation.

01 • Assistant: The updated list says twelve trays. Are those twelve additional trays or the overall total?

02 • Cook: Twelve is the total needed. Four trays have already been counted as complete for this assignment.

03 • Assistant: Then eight remain, assuming those four belong to the same order on this updated sheet.

04 • Cook: They do. The completed trays carry the same order reference as the revised list.

05 • Assistant: I'll work toward eight more, rather than adding twelve to the four already finished.

06 • Cook: Exactly. Please don't count the separate display tray toward this order; it belongs elsewhere.

07 • Assistant: Thanks for pointing that out. Is the display tray included in any of these figures?

08 • Cook: No, it's listed on the counter-service sheet and isn't part of today's twelve-tray order.

09 • Assistant: I'll keep the two counts separate when I report the remaining work to the lead.

10 • Cook: That will help. Report eight outstanding on this order and leave the display count unchanged.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Prep ready for whom?

A cook checks what a colleague means by 'ready'.

01 • Cook: You said my mise en place was ready. Is the garnish at my station yet?

02 • Colleague: It's prepared on the prep bench, but I haven't transferred it to your station yet.

03 • Cook: Thanks. I was looking in the station supplies and thought we had run out.

04 • Colleague: We haven't run out. The completed garnish is assigned to your station on this list.

05 • Cook: Could you confirm the quantity? I need to report our remaining prep before service starts.

06 • Colleague: There are eighteen portions for your station, and another six belong to the lunch counter.

07 • Cook: I'll report eighteen prepared for us, with the transfer still outstanding at this moment.

08 • Colleague: Yes, and please keep the lunch-counter allocation separate so it doesn't get counted twice.

09 • Cook: Who's bringing it over? I can collect it once we've finished this handover.

10 • Colleague: Please take that task. I'll tell the lead it's assigned to you, not already complete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying a prep list

The prep list says 'soup: 24' without a unit. Yesterday's sheet used portions; the storeroom label uses containers. The lead intended 24 portions from the current recipe, not 24 containers. No batch has started.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Lead cook: confirm 24 portions using Monday's recipe; container numbers are storage counts.

Second round: The cook finds a second sheet dated Friday. Identify which sheet governs today's task.

Scenario 2 | A handwritten abbreviation

A prep note reads '6 c.' The recipe uses cups, but the delivery list uses cases. The lead intended six cups for a practice recipe discussion; no preparation has begun.

Role A: Cook: ask what the abbreviation means.

Role B: Lead: expand it to cups and identify the recipe, not a delivery order.

Possible opening: Could you spell out the unit beside the six?

Success checks

- Identify the current document.
- Obtain the full unit.
- Repeat the quantity without using the ambiguous abbreviation.

Add a complication: A colleague says the same abbreviation meant cases yesterday.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Six on paper, four on the floor

The tomato delivery count in the case.

01 • Cook: The delivery note lists six tomato cases, but I counted four beside this trolley.

02 • Receiving lead: Did the driver say the remaining two are missing, or just somewhere else?

03 • Cook: They said two might be on another trolley. They haven't actually checked it yet.

04 • Receiving lead: Then we have four observed and two unconfirmed. Please show me the delivery note.

05 • Cook: Here it is. I haven't recorded all six as received because the count doesn't match.

06 • Receiving lead: Good. I'll ask the driver to reconcile the physical count before we complete the record.

07 • Cook: Should I describe this as a confirmed short delivery in the kitchen update now?

08 • Receiving lead: Say two cases are currently unaccounted for. We haven't established whether they arrived elsewhere.

09 • Cook: Understood. I'll report four here and the remaining two under review with you.

10 • Receiving lead: Thank you. That gives the kitchen a usable count without assigning a cause prematurely.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A label cannot be read

A kitchen assistant reports an unreadable product identifier.

01 • Assistant: This container's product label is readable, but the lot code underneath it is obscured.

02 • Lead cook: Can you connect it to the matching delivery record, or is that link unclear too?

03 • Assistant: The product name matches, but there are two deliveries with different codes on today's sheet.

04 • Lead cook: Then don't guess which code belongs to it. I'll ask the receiving team to check.

05 • Assistant: I'll leave its status unresolved and identify the exact container in my report to them.

06 • Lead cook: Please mention that the product name is visible; it's the lot code that needs clarification.

07 • Assistant: Would a photograph of the label help them identify which area is unreadable here?

08 • Lead cook: Use our normal reporting method and keep the original container available for their inspection.

09 • Assistant: I'll describe the obscured code and the two possible delivery records without choosing between them.

10 • Lead cook: We need the correct lot code for traceability. Don't copy one from another container.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Stock on hand versus available

A cook checks whether counted portions are already allocated.

01 • Cook: You counted twenty tart portions. Are all twenty available for tonight's dining room service?

02 • Prep colleague: No, six are allocated to the staff event. Fourteen remain available for the dining room.

03 • Cook: Thanks. The stock board just says twenty, so I nearly reported the whole count as available.

04 • Prep colleague: Let's distinguish the physical total from the allocation. Both numbers matter to the shift lead.

05 • Cook: I'll report twenty on hand, six reserved for the event, and fourteen for service.

06 • Prep colleague: That's right. The six aren't missing or already served; they're assigned to a different use.

07 • Cook: Has the event allocation changed since the last count, or is six still confirmed?

08 • Prep colleague: Six is confirmed on the event list. No one has requested a change to that number.

09 • Cook: I'll add that distinction to my spoken update so the server doesn't sell the reserved portions.

10 • Prep colleague: Please do. I'll check with the lead before any reserved portion is reassigned to service.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reporting deliveries and stock discrepancies

The delivery note lists six cases of tomatoes; four are physically present. The driver says two may be on another trolley but has not checked. The receiving lead must resolve the record. Report the observed count without accusing the supplier or recording six as received.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Driver: six are on the note; you haven't checked the second trolley yet.

Second round: The driver finds one more case. Update the observed count to five without declaring the delivery complete.

Scenario 2 | One box is a different product

A delivery note lists five cases of plain rolls. There are four plain-roll cases and one seeded-roll case. No substitution was agreed.

Role A: Cook: state counts and product names.

Role B: Receiving lead: review the mismatch with the supplier before accepting a substitution.

Possible opening: The fifth case has a different product description.

Success checks

- Count by product, not just container.
- Avoid declaring the substitute equivalent.
- Identify the unresolved substitution decision.

Add a complication: A colleague calls it 'five bread cases' and overlooks the product difference.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Three total, not five

Revised ticket 41 from the case.

01 • Cook: Revised forty-one says three tarts. Does that replace the original two or add another three?

02 • Expediter: It replaces the original quantity. The table needs three tarts total on that ticket.

03 • Cook: Thanks. I also see salad instead of potatoes, but the note doesn't identify a quantity.

04 • Expediter: That substitution belongs to one tart only. The other two keep their standard potatoes.

05 • Cook: So three tarts total: one with salad, two with potatoes. Is that the complete revision?

06 • Expediter: Yes. Don't combine the old ticket quantity with the new one when you count orders.

07 • Cook: I'll use the revised ticket and tell the other station the original quantity was replaced.

08 • Expediter: Please identify forty-one in that message; another table has a separate order for two tarts.

09 • Cook: Understood. The revision changes forty-one only and leaves the other table's order untouched.

10 • Expediter: Correct. Read back the table and ticket if another correction comes through during service.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

What does all day include?

A cook checks the scope of an order total.

01 • Cook: You called six soups all day. Does that include the two on the new takeaway ticket?

02 • Expediter: Yes, six includes those two. Four belong to dining-room tickets and two to takeaway.

03 • Cook: Thanks. I was about to add the takeaway pair again and report eight instead.

04 • Expediter: Keep the total at six. The separate packing instruction doesn't create two extra portions.

05 • Cook: Which ticket has the takeaway pair? I want the service format attached to the right order.

06 • Expediter: Ticket fifty-three. The other four portions are listed across the two dining-room tickets beside it.

07 • Cook: I'll repeat six total, with two assigned to takeaway ticket fifty-three and four for tables.

08 • Expediter: Exactly. Tell me if a cancellation arrives before treating that total as unchanged.

09 • Cook: No cancellation has reached me. I'll keep the current six unless you issue a revision.

10 • Expediter: Good. That gives both the quantity and the order split without counting anything twice.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Urgent is not specific

A cook clarifies an urgent verbal request.

01 • Expediter: I need a replacement tart on the fly for the table near the window.

02 • Cook: Which table number and ticket? There are three window tables in tonight's seating arrangement.

03 • Expediter: Table eighteen, ticket sixty. The original plate was the wrong dish and needs replacing.

04 • Cook: Thank you. Does the replacement keep the standard side, or is there a modification?

05 • Expediter: It needs salad instead of potatoes. That was on the original ticket for this diner.

06 • Cook: I'll read that back: replacement tart for eighteen, ticket sixty, salad instead of potatoes.

07 • Expediter: Correct. Please give me an estimate rather than assuming the urgency makes it immediately available.

08 • Cook: I'll check the station's current work and give you a realistic estimate for this replacement.

09 • Expediter: Thanks. I'll tell the server the request is accepted, with the estimate still pending.

10 • Cook: I'll call the ticket number with that estimate so it doesn't get attached elsewhere.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reading tickets and modifications

Ticket 41 originally has two tarts. A new slip says 'three tarts, revised 41.' The expediter confirms this replaces the old quantity, so the total is three, not five. One tart has salad instead of potatoes. Confirm quantity and substitution.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Expediter: confirm three total, one salad substitution, and two standard accompaniments.

Second round: Someone calls 'three more' after the correction. Repair the quantity before work continues.

Scenario 2 | A canceled side remains on a screen

Ticket 72 originally includes two extra salads. The expediter confirms one extra salad is canceled; the mains are unchanged.

Role A: Cook: clarify the remaining quantity.

Role B: Expediter: confirm one extra salad remains and both mains still stand.

Possible opening: Does this cancellation remove one salad or the whole ticket?

Success checks

- Keep both mains.
- State one extra salad remains.
- Repeat the ticket number when correcting the colleague.

Add a complication: A colleague heard only the word 'cancel'.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Half a ticket is not a pickup

Ticket 28 from the case.

01 • Expediter: Can I call the pickup for twenty-eight? I see two plated mains at the pass.

02 • Cook: Not yet. There are four mains on that ticket, and two are still at my station.

03 • Expediter: How long do you estimate for the remaining pair, taking your current work into account?

04 • Cook: Approximately four more minutes. I'll tell you if that changes before the full ticket is ready.

05 • Expediter: I'll keep the pickup open, then. Are those two plated dishes definitely for twenty-eight?

06 • Cook: Yes, their ticket is beside them. They aren't part of the neighboring order for twenty-nine.

07 • Expediter: Good. The runner nearly combined them with that order because the plates looked similar.

08 • Cook: I'll keep the table reference clear and call you when the remaining pair reaches the pass.

09 • Expediter: Please do. I'll coordinate the full pickup after checking all four against the ticket.

10 • Cook: Understood. Two plated, two pending, with the current estimate still four more minutes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A garnish mismatch at the pass

An expeditor questions a visible difference between a dish and its ticket.

01 • Expediter: This ticket says no herb garnish, but the plate here has herbs on top.

02 • Cook: Let me check the ticket number before assuming that plate belongs to the modified order.

03 • Expediter: It's thirty-four, seat two. The dish beside it is the standard version for seat one.

04 • Cook: You're right. I've matched the standard plate to the wrong seat at the pass.

05 • Expediter: What is the next step for the modified dish? I haven't released either plate.

06 • Cook: I'll check the preparation status with the station lead and give you a confirmed correction.

07 • Expediter: Please keep the modification attached to seat two rather than changing both dishes on this ticket.

08 • Cook: Understood. One standard dish for seat one, one no-garnish order for seat two.

09 • Expediter: Tell me when the corrected pickup is ready for checking; don't just call the whole table done.

10 • Cook: I will name thirty-four and the two seat assignments when I return with the update.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The runner needs the whole location

A cook repairs a vague pickup announcement.

01 • Runner: You called the back table, but there are several tables beyond the partition tonight.

02 • Cook: I meant table twenty-six. Let me give the full number rather than a location nickname.

03 • Runner: Thank you. Are all three dishes here for twenty-six, or does one belong elsewhere?

04 • Cook: Only the two marked plates are for twenty-six. The third belongs to table sixteen.

05 • Runner: Then I'll collect the two confirmed dishes and leave sixteen's plate beside its own ticket.

06 • Cook: Please check with the expeditor first; they're coordinating whether twenty-six's side dish joins this pickup.

07 • Runner: I hadn't seen a side dish on the runner copy. I'll ask about that before leaving.

08 • Cook: Good. My call identified the two mains, not whether the entire order was complete.

09 • Runner: The expeditor confirms the side is still pending and wants this pickup held for now.

10 • Cook: I'll keep the plates identified and let them make the next pickup call.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Coordinating the pass

Ticket 28 has four mains. Two are plated; two are still at the cook's station. The cook estimates four more minutes for the remaining pair. The expediter asks whether the whole table is ready. Report partial progress and the current estimate.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Expediter: ask what is plated and whether the estimate covers the remaining pair.

Second round: The runner points to the two plated dishes and assumes the whole ticket can leave.

Scenario 2 | A takeaway order at the dining pass

Three containers for takeaway ticket 90 are ready, but the printed order lists four. The fourth is still at the dessert station.

Role A: Cook: report three ready and one pending.

Role B: Expediter: identify the missing dessert and obtain its estimate.

Possible opening: Is ticket ninety complete for collection?

Success checks

- Compare containers with the ticket.
- Name the missing component.
- Avoid declaring the whole order ready.

Add a complication: The courier asks whether seeing three containers means they can leave.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Three portions for five orders

The potato shortage in the case.

01 • Cook: The potato portion count is three, but this ticket asks for five sides.

02 • Server: Could you put rice on the other two plates and let me explain afterward?

03 • Cook: Please ask first. Rice is available, but we don't know which diners would accept it.

04 • Server: You're right. I'll offer rice to the table and get the actual seat choices.

05 • Cook: Thank you. Keep the three available potatoes separate from any portions already committed elsewhere.

06 • Server: Do you have enough rice for both proposed changes if two diners choose it?

07 • Cook: Yes, two rice sides are available for this proposal. Neither substitution is confirmed yet.

08 • Server: I'll return with the names of the two seats, or tell you if they decline.

09 • Cook: Then I'll read back the five sides against those seats before the ticket proceeds.

10 • Server: Agreed. I'll describe the shortage clearly rather than call rice the standard accompaniment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A stock word needs a scope

A cook clarifies whether a shortage concerns one dish or an ingredient.

01 • Cook: You called the mushrooms eighty-six. Do you mean the mushroom starter or every dish containing mushrooms?

02 • Expediter: The mushroom starter only. The pasta station has its own allocated ingredient stock for service.

03 • Cook: Thanks. I'll tell the servers the starter is unavailable, not remove the pasta from their options.

04 • Expediter: Please use the full dish name. The shortened call caused confusion at the other station too.

05 • Cook: Is the starter unavailable for the rest of this service, or just while another batch is checked?

06 • Expediter: The lead has marked it unavailable for tonight. No further starter batch is planned.

07 • Cook: I'll repeat that as mushroom starter unavailable tonight, with mushroom pasta availability unchanged.

08 • Expediter: Exactly. The separate allocation is why the dish name matters more than the ingredient nickname.

09 • Cook: I'll also check earlier starter orders before discussing replacements.

10 • Expediter: The lead is checking earlier tickets separately; the starter is unavailable for new orders tonight.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A par level is not an order

A prep cook questions a replenishment request.

01 • Prep cook: The par level says forty portions, but we have twenty and only ten orders expected.

02 • Lead cook: Are you asking whether to prepare twenty more just to reach the reference level?

03 • Prep cook: Yes. I don't want to treat the printed par figure as a new production instruction.

04 • Lead cook: That's sensible. Today's approved prep target stays at twenty because the service plan is smaller.

05 • Prep cook: Then the existing twenty meet today's target, even though they're below the usual par level.

06 • Lead cook: Correct. The par is a planning reference, not an automatic instruction for every shift.

07 • Prep cook: Should I tell the incoming cook why the board shows a difference from that reference?

08 • Lead cook: Please do. Explain the reduced target so they don't add an unnecessary batch later.

09 • Prep cook: I'll say twenty available against today's target of twenty, with the usual par unchanged at forty.

10 • Lead cook: Exactly. Any further production needs a new decision based on the service update, not the gap alone.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Communicating a shortage and an alternative

Three portions of potatoes remain unallocated, but a new ticket requests five. Rice is available as a proposed alternative side; the server must check whether two diners accept it. The cook cannot silently substitute. Agree who obtains the diners' decision.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Server: you can ask the five diners, but cannot choose two seats for them.

Second round: Only one diner accepts rice. Restate the remaining shortage and ask the lead about another option.

Scenario 2 | Only the garnish is unavailable

The herb garnish for a soup is unavailable. The soup itself remains available, but any presentation change needs the lead's decision and a server update.

Role A: Cook: identify the missing component, not the entire dish.

Role B: Lead: confirm whether a no-garnish presentation can be offered; no decision exists at the opening.

Possible opening: Are we marking the whole soup unavailable or just reporting the garnish shortage?

Success checks

- Separate component and dish.
- Obtain the lead's decision.
- Correct the server's earlier message accurately.

Add a complication: A colleague has already told one server 'no soup'.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A modifier is not an allergy clearance

Ticket 17 from the case.

01 • Server: The no-cheese request on seventeen is about a milk allergy, not a taste preference.

02 • Cook: Thanks for the new information. Omitting cheese doesn't answer whether the sauce contains milk ingredients.

03 • Server: I had described the dish as suitable once the cheese was removed. That was too broad.

04 • Cook: Please correct that with the guest. The sauce specification and handling question still need the lead's review.

05 • Server: I'll keep the order pending and explain that we need to check the whole preparation.

06 • Cook: I'll give the lead the ticket number and the guest's exact reported concern about milk.

07 • Server: Should I bring the guest another menu while the lead gathers the relevant information?

08 • Cook: You can offer one, but don't name another dish as suitable without its own check.

09 • Server: Understood. I'll explain the unresolved question and invite the lead to discuss it directly with them.

10 • Cook: That lets the diner choose using actual information, not our assumption.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A recipe version matters

A cook finds two ingredient sheets for the same sauce.

01 • Cook: There are two recipe specifications for the sauce, and their ingredient lists don't match.

02 • Lead cook: Are the documents dated, and can you identify which one the current batch refers to?

03 • Cook: The sheets have different dates, but I can't confirm which was used for this batch.

04 • Lead cook: Then don't answer the server from whichever sheet looks newer. We need the batch's actual information.

05 • Cook: I'll keep the suitability question unresolved and show you the two sheets and batch reference.

06 • Lead cook: Please do. What exactly did the diner ask so we check the right concern?

07 • Cook: They asked whether the sauce contains mustard. The server has not reported an allergy or preference yet.

08 • Lead cook: I'll ask the server to clarify that too, without delaying the ingredient-record check you've raised.

09 • Cook: So the batch's allergen declaration and the guest's exact concern both need checking?

10 • Lead cook: I'll handle the recipe review; please obtain the guest's exact wording.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A vegetarian label needs confirmation

A cook questions a proposed menu description without offering dietary certification.

01 • Server: A guest wants the soup without the meat garnish. Can I describe that as vegetarian?

02 • Cook: Not from that change alone. The base recipe matters, and I haven't checked its stock ingredients.

03 • Server: The garnish is the only meat I can see, which is why I thought it worked.

04 • Cook: Visible ingredients don't describe the whole recipe. Let's get the current specification from the lead.

05 • Server: I'll tell the guest removing the garnish is a request, not confirmation of the soup's composition.

06 • Cook: Good. Did they ask about a dietary preference, or report a specific allergy we should relay?

07 • Server: They stated a vegetarian preference. They didn't mention an allergy, and I won't add that label.

08 • Cook: Please pass on that exact preference while we check whether this recipe meets the request.

09 • Server: I'll leave the soup unconfirmed and discuss other choices only with verified ingredient information.

10 • Cook: That avoids turning an appearance-based guess into a menu claim.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Checking dietary modifications

Ticket 17 says 'no cheese.' The server then reports that the diner has a milk allergy. The sauce specification has not been checked. The cook must not treat omission of cheese as confirmation that the dish is suitable; the lead can review it with the server.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Server: the milk allergy was reported after the initial no-cheese modifier. Relay that change exactly.

Second round: The guest says another restaurant makes it without cheese. Explain why that doesn't verify this recipe.

Scenario 2 | A product changes midweek

A sauce now uses a new branded ingredient. A previous allergen declaration is available, but the new product's declaration has not been checked.

Role A: Cook: question use of the old declaration.

Role B: Lead: obtain the current product information before answering the server.

Possible opening: Does the older declaration cover this new product?

Success checks

- Identify the product change.
- Avoid assuming equivalence.
- Keep the specific dietary question unresolved pending review.

Add a complication: The products have similar packaging and the same descriptive name.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A blank display is the observation

The scale problem from the case.

01 • Cook: I'm reporting an equipment fault with scale B at pastry prep: its display keeps going blank.

02 • Lead cook: Do you know the cause, or are you reporting only what the display did?

03 • Cook: Only what I observed. I don't know whether the issue is with power or the scale itself.

04 • Lead cook: I'll mark scale B out of service for review. Can you show me its label?

05 • Cook: Could you also confirm whether scale A is available so this prep can continue?

06 • Lead cook: I'll check its availability. Has the pastry quantity already been verified by another method?

07 • Cook: No, that quantity remains unverified. I haven't reported this part of the prep as complete.

08 • Lead cook: Then keep that status clear. I'll bring you a confirmed equipment option after checking.

09 • Cook: Should I give the next cook the device label and location in the handover?

10 • Lead cook: Yes, identify scale B at pastry prep, with review pending and no repair time confirmed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A specific request for the dish team

A cook requests needed plates during a busy service.

01 • Cook: Could you check the availability of small soup bowls? Our station has four left.

02 • Dish colleague: One dish rack of small bowls is in progress, but I don't have a completion time.

03 • Cook: The bowls are the bottleneck now: six soup orders are pending, and we only have four.

04 • Dish colleague: Are you asking for all the bowls from that rack or just the immediate shortfall?

05 • Cook: The immediate shortfall is two bowls. The lead can decide how to allocate the rest.

06 • Dish colleague: I'll tell the lead that number and update you when the rack is ready.

07 • Cook: Please identify small soup bowls, not the larger pasta bowls stored beside them.

08 • Dish colleague: Understood. Is there a completed rack elsewhere that you've already checked for this size?

09 • Cook: I checked our station shelf only. I haven't checked the other approved storage location.

10 • Dish colleague: I'll confirm that location with the lead so we don't duplicate the same search.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A noisy machine needs a location

A kitchen assistant clarifies an equipment report.

01 • Assistant: There's an unusual noise from the dish area, but I haven't identified which machine is involved.

02 • Supervisor: Are you reporting the sound itself, or did you see a particular machine malfunction?

03 • Assistant: The sound only. I don't want to label the dishwasher faulty without checking with the operator.

04 • Supervisor: Good distinction. I'll speak with the dish lead and determine the appropriate response.

05 • Assistant: Should I tell the kitchen all dish service has stopped because of the noise?

06 • Supervisor: No, we haven't established that. Report the concern and keep any service impact unconfirmed.

07 • Assistant: I'll say the dish lead is reviewing an unusual noise, without naming a failed component.

08 • Supervisor: Please also tell me when you first noticed it so the report has a clear reference.

09 • Assistant: I noticed it just after eight, while collecting clean trays near the entrance.

10 • Supervisor: Thank you. That location and time are useful; a guessed diagnosis wouldn't improve the report.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reporting equipment and dish-station needs

The display on scale B at the pastry prep bench keeps going blank. No cause is known. The cook has stopped using it and needs the lead to arrange review and confirm whether scale A is available. Do not offer repair instructions.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Lead: you can arrange review; scale A's availability is not yet confirmed.

Second round: The colleague asks whether the fault will be fixed before service. Keep the completion time unconfirmed.

Scenario 2 | Two similar equipment labels

A colleague reports 'mixer two' unavailable, but prep uses labels M2 and M12. The supervisor knows M12 is under review; M2's status is unchanged.

Role A: Cook: clarify the exact label.

Role B: Supervisor: identify M12 and the review status.

Possible opening: Do you mean M2 or M12?

Success checks

- Obtain the exact label.
- Repeat the affected location and device.
- Avoid declaring both devices unavailable.

Add a complication: The caller says 'the big one,' but both look similar from your station.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Recorded is not reviewed

The shift-change case with garnish, waste entry, and shelf check.

01 • Outgoing cook: Twelve garnish portions are counted. Two items on the closing checklist are still open.

02 • Incoming cook: Which items are open, and which one are you asking me to take over?

03 • Outgoing cook: The shelf check hasn't been done. Could you complete that check and report its status?

04 • Incoming cook: Yes, I'll take the shelf check. What is the second unfinished item on your list?

05 • Outgoing cook: The waste log lists three damaged tarts; the lead hasn't reviewed that entry yet.

06 • Incoming cook: Will you keep responsibility for that review, or do you want me to ask the lead?

07 • Outgoing cook: I'll keep the review follow-up. You only need to take the shelf check from this handover.

08 • Incoming cook: Understood. Twelve garnish portions counted; shelf check mine; waste review still yours and pending.

09 • Outgoing cook: Exactly. Please don't interpret the recorded waste entry as a completed sign-off by the lead.

10 • Incoming cook: I'll do the shelf check and let you know when it's finished.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A waste reason is unknown

A cook checks a proposed explanation for discarded food.

01 • Cook: The log says four portions discarded, but the reason column is blank on this entry.

02 • Lead cook: Do you know why they were discarded, or only how many were recorded here?

03 • Cook: Only the quantity. A colleague suggested it was an order cancellation, but hasn't confirmed that.

04 • Lead cook: Then don't add that explanation as fact. Ask the person who handled the discard.

05 • Cook: I'll keep the reason unresolved while requesting clarification, rather than choose the most likely category.

06 • Lead cook: Good. Is the quantity itself supported by a count, or does that also need checking?

07 • Cook: The colleague confirmed counting four portions. They couldn't explain why the decision was made.

08 • Lead cook: So we have a confirmed count and an unconfirmed reason. Keep those two statuses distinct.

09 • Cook: I'll tell the incoming cook exactly that and identify who is following up on the reason.

10 • Lead cook: Please take that follow-up yourself and bring me the answer for the record review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Carryover is not permission

An incoming cook asks what an unfinished stock note establishes.

01 • Incoming cook: The handover mentions carryover sauce. Does that mean it's approved for use in today's service?

02 • Outgoing cook: No. The note identifies remaining stock, but the lead still needs to confirm its status.

03 • Incoming cook: Thank you. I won't read a remaining quantity as permission to use it.

04 • Outgoing cook: Exactly. The relevant records are with the lead, and I haven't made that decision.

05 • Incoming cook: Do you have a confirmed quantity so I can describe what's waiting for review?

06 • Outgoing cook: Two labeled containers are listed. I haven't converted that container count into a portion yield.

07 • Incoming cook: I'll report two containers with review pending, not a guessed number of available portions.

08 • Outgoing cook: That's accurate. The new prep plan depends on the lead's decision and the verified yield.

09 • Incoming cook: I'll ask for both details before treating the carryover as part of my available stock.

10 • Outgoing cook: Please do. I'll remain available to explain the earlier note if the lead needs context.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Closing and handing over unfinished work

At shift change, the garnish count is complete at twelve portions, the waste-log entry for three damaged tarts awaits the lead's review, and the closing shelf check has not been performed. Ask the incoming cook to accept the shelf check without treating the waste review as complete.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Incoming cook: accept the shelf check and ask who retains the waste-log follow-up.

Second round: The lead is unavailable now. Keep review pending rather than treating silence as sign-off.

Scenario 2 | A checklist mark lacks initials

A closing checklist has a tick beside the storage check, but no name or time. Neither cook knows who completed it. The lead can clarify or arrange a new check.

Role A: Outgoing cook: report the ambiguous mark.

Role B: Incoming cook: ask who will verify completion.

Possible opening: Does this tick show a completed check we can actually confirm?

Success checks

- Avoid inferring completion from handwriting.
- Keep status unverified.
- Assign the verification question to the lead.

Add a complication: A colleague says the tick looks like yesterday's handwriting.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All situations, quantities, recipes, times, and product details are fictional English practice, not culinary certification or food-safety instruction. This course does not teach cooking temperatures, chemical use, equipment repair, or allergen-control procedures. Follow workplace training and the responsible kitchen lead's decisions. It concerns kitchen communication rather than hospitality management.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook: Cooks

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/food-preparation-and-serving/cooks.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Cooks, Restaurant

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/35-2014.00>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Cooks and Kitchen Staff English

Professional audience: Line cooks, prep cooks, kitchen assistants, and dish-team colleagues

Scope: All situations, quantities, recipes, times, and product details are fictional English practice, not culinary certification or food-safety instruction. This course does not teach cooking temperatures, chemical use, equipment repair, or allergen-control procedures. Follow workplace training and the responsible kitchen lead's decisions. It concerns kitchen communication rather than hospitality management.

Dialogue 01: A revised event count reaches the kitchen

Original fictional setting: A prep cook checks how a changed meal count affects an existing assignment.

Professional roles: Prep cook / Lead cook

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Prep cook: The event count changed from thirty to thirty-six. Does that change every item on my prep list?

Lead cook: Not every item. The organizer added six main meals, but the dessert count remains at thirty today.

Prep cook: I have one sheet saying thirty portions throughout. Is there an updated list showing the different targets?

Lead cook: Yes, this revision separates the mains from desserts. Please use it instead of the earlier combined sheet.

Prep cook: The soup appears as a starter on the old list. Are six extra starters included as well?

Lead cook: That hasn't been confirmed. Keep the starter target at thirty while I ask the event contact directly.

Prep cook: Then I can report thirty-six mains and thirty desserts confirmed, with the possible extra starters still open?

Lead cook: Exactly. Don't turn the revised attendance figure into an instruction to increase every component by six.

Prep cook: Who should tell the other prep cook? They may still be using the old combined list over there.

Lead cook: I'll brief them now. Could you read back your two confirmed targets before you return to your station?

Prep cook: Thirty-six main portions and thirty desserts. The starter quantity stays at thirty unless you confirm a further change.

Lead cook: Correct. I'll return with a specific starter decision.

Vocabulary in this exchange: prep list: A list of ingredients or components to prepare before or during service.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.

Use voice replies when available. If I prefer selections, offer four plausible spoken replies and explain my choice before continuing. Do not require written compositions.

END PROMPT

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

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When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

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Lead cook: Correct. I'll return with a specific starter decision.

Vocabulary in this exchange: prep list: A list of ingredients or components to prepare before or during service.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT